

BMA343 Digital & Social Media Marketing

Assignment Three: Digital & Social Media Marketing Plan

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2. Executive Summary

This Digital and Social Media Marketing (DSMM) plan provides a comprehensive, data-driven strategic roadmap designed to transform the digital presence of A Spring Food Bar, an authentic Chinese restaurant located in the Hobart CBD, Tasmania. While the business enjoys strong offline operational foundations and local culinary trust, its digital maturity is currently low. This creates a severe strategic disconnect where physical positioning strengths fail to communicate to online audiences, leaving the restaurant highly dependent on low-margin third-party delivery platforms.

A rigorous digital SWOT analysis reveals key internal strengths, including an integrated online ordering system and an exceptional customer trust rating above 4.6 stars on Google. However, these are constrained by severe digital weaknesses: zero active social media channels, thin website content, and a weak link profile containing only 4 external backlinks. To bridge these gaps, the plan identifies lucrative external opportunities to capture two distinct digital target segments—Local Hobart Families and Chinese International Students—by leveraging high-growth short-form video trends and localised search visibility, while mitigating threats from aggressive CBD competitors and rising third-party commission fees.

To operationalise growth, this plan establishes three interconnected SMART objectives over a rolling three-month horizon: increasing organic website traffic by 25%, growing the total volume of Google reviews by 20% while sustaining the 4.6-star benchmark, and acquiring 500 highly localised social media followers.

These objectives are systematically executed through the strategic PESO framework. Owned media optimises the website structure with hyper-local search phrases. Shared media launches synchronised TikTok and Instagram Reels channels utilising the AIDA framework and bilingual content. Earned media deploys active in-store review prompts, and paid media accelerates dine-in conversion through hyper-targeted Meta advertising and local food influencer partnerships. Operating on a structured \$6,000 AUD budget over 12 months, this plan provides four distinct, actionable recommendations grounded in marketing theory, ensuring strict compliance with the Australian Privacy Act 1988 and Spam Act 2003 to drive sustainable dine-in traffic and long-term digital asset equity.

3. Introduction

3.1 Company Background

A Spring Food Bar is a local small business located at 93 Elizabeth Street in the Hobart CBD, Tasmania. The restaurant offers authentic Chinese cuisine for dine-in, takeaway, and direct online ordering. Situated in the city centre, its physical location is highly convenient for three main customer segments: local city residents, University of Tasmania (UTAS) students, and corporate office workers. The restaurant operates an official website for menus and direct orders. However, its overall digital marketing maturity is basic, because it currently lacks active social media channels or interactive content engagement (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016).

3.2 Company Mission, Vision, and Objectives

- **Mission:** As stated on its website, the mission is: "constantly striving to improve our service and quality in order to give our customers the very best experience" (A Spring Food Bar, n.d.).
- **Vision:** To become the top-of-mind, most trusted local choice for authentic Chinese dining and convenient takeaway services in Greater Hobart.
- **Business Objectives:** Short-term operational goals focus on attracting local residents and students for physical dine-in, maintaining high customer ratings on review platforms, and increasing direct website orders to reduce third-party fees.

Currently, the business successfully focuses on daily operations but lacks clear, data-driven long-term plans for digital marketing and online brand growth.

3.3 Overall Marketing Strategy and Objectives

A Spring Food Bar differentiates itself in the Hobart market by focusing on culinary authenticity. Its traditional marketing mix (7Ps) parameters are highly distinct within the local hospitality sector:

- **Product:** Focuses on fresh, traditional, and authentic Chinese dishes.
- **Price:** Utilises affordable, value-driven mid-tier pricing.
- **Place:** Combines the central physical CBD venue with integrated third-party delivery applications.
- **Promotion:** Relies heavily on passive organic word-of-mouth and customer referrals.

- People: Deploys polite, bilingual front-of-house staff to assist both local and international patrons.
- Process: Operates a dual-stream ordering system separating physical table service from digital takeaway collection.
- Physical Evidence: Maintains a clean, brightly lit, and contemporary dining environment in a high-foot-traffic location (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016).

Critically evaluating the alignment with firm positioning reveals a severe strategic gap. The restaurant traditionally positions itself as a high-quality, authentic, and clean dining venue. However, its complete lack of social media presence and thin website content create an online digital vacuum. This means the restaurant's excellent physical brand positioning fails to communicate to digital audiences, resulting in a strategic disconnect where cold digital channels do not support offline strengths. This plan bridges this gap by aligning digital touchpoints directly with traditional core values.

4. Digital and Social Media Situation Analysis (Digital SWOT)	
STRENGTHS (Internal)	WEAKNESSES (Internal)
○ Robust Direct Online Ordering Integration: The website features a secure, user-friendly portal for direct orders, effectively reducing checkout friction compared to third-party platforms (Leachman & Scheibenreif, 2023). ○ High Verified Organic Digital Trust: The restaurant maintains an outstanding average rating above 4.6 stars on Google based on authentic customer reviews, serving as powerful digital social proof (Chakravorti et al., 2021).	○ Complete Social Media Absence: The restaurant operates no official brand channels on Instagram, Facebook, or TikTok, rendering the brand invisible to digital-first consumer demographics (Quesenberry, 2016). ○ Deficient External Backlink Profile: The domain contains only 4 external referring backlinks, severely limiting its organic search authority and visibility on non-branded local keywords

○ Local Geo-Targeted Domain Authority: The clean, verified .com.au top-level domain enhances local geographical relevance and crawling advantages for Tasmanian search engines. ○ Mobile Optimization of Menu Interface: The direct web ordering platform is fully responsive and automatically scaled for mobile devices, aligning with the on-the-go browsing patterns of local inner-city diners.	(Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016). ○ Thin Media and Narrative Content: The web platform displays a basic text-based menu layout with zero high-definition food photography, dynamic video assets, or authentic brand stories (Leachman & Scheibenreif, 2023). ○ Absence of Digital Analytics Infrastructure: The current website lacks integrated tracking mechanisms, such as Google Analytics 4 (GA4) tags or Meta Pixels, preventing data-driven conversion tracking or target remarketing.
OPPORTUNITIES (External)	THREATS (External)
○ Short-Form Visual Food Marketing Trends: The massive organic reach of culinary lifestyle content on TikTok and Instagram Reels (e.g., #HobartEats) allows independent venues to scale visual brand engagement efficiently (Collis & Collis, 2020). ○ Socially Driven Local Market Demographics: High local concentrations of CBD corporate	○ Aggressive Digital Footprint of CBD Competitors: Immediate local rivals on Elizabeth Street, such as HEJO's Chinese Restaurant and Monsoon Shabu Shabu, maintain highly visual web architectures and active social platforms to capture organic CBD search share. ○ Erosion of Profit Margins by Delivery Aggregators: High commission fees from third-party delivery applications (e.g., Uber Eats) severely cannibalise operational profits and detach the firm from direct customer data

office workers and over 20,000 UTAS students rely heavily on mobile social feeds to discover group dining options (Quesenberry, 2016).

- Conversion-Oriented User Experience (UX) Optimisation: Integrating professional food imagery and automated social review widgets into SME platforms can boost online transactional conversion rates by over 20%(Leachman & Scheibenreif, 2023).
- Bilingual Digital Target Engagement: Deploying synchronised dual-language content (English and Chinese) allows the business to tap directly into the international student and migrant segments within Greater Hobart.

access (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016).

- Unpredictable Platform Algorithmic Volatility: Frequent shifts in Meta and TikTok discovery feed algorithms threaten to limit organic channel exposure without continuous paid ad backing.
- Evolving Australian Digital Compliance Frameworks: Stricter regulatory enforcement of online consumer reviews and data transparency under the Privacy Act 1988 increases compliance pressure on small business web infrastructures.

5. DSMM Objectives, Digital STP, and Digital Value Proposition

To enhance online performance, A Spring Food Bar sets three SMART objectives: increase organic website traffic by 25% within 3 months via local SEO; expand Google reviews by 20% within 3 months while sustaining a 4.6-star rating; and gain 500 local social media followers within 4 weeks.

The market is segmented into two distinct digital consumer targets (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016):

- **Local Hobart Families (Primary Target):** Parents aged 25–55 in Greater Hobart with mid-to-high disposable income (demographics). They prioritise venue cleanliness and food safety (psychographics), exhibit high-value multi-dish group ordering (behavioural), and rely on Google Maps and Instagram to verify reviews and dining environments before booking (digital-usage). *Justification:* This segment generates large transaction sizes and high-value dine-in traffic, directly aligning with the restaurant's operational strengths of cleanliness and high trust ratings.
- **Hobart Chinese Consumers and Students (Secondary Target):** Chinese international students (primarily UTAS) and young migrants aged 18–40 (demographics). Driven by cultural nostalgia and culinary authenticity within tight diaspora networks (psychographics), they exhibit high weekly dining and takeaway frequencies (behavioural). They heavily consume short-form video daily on TikTok and Instagram Reels using smartphone discovery tools (digital-usage). *Justification:* They have an inherent organic demand for authentic Chinese tastes and respond rapidly to bilingual digital content, serving as ideal catalysts for local online word-of-mouth.

For digital positioning, the restaurant establishes itself as the premier choice for the cleanest, most authentic group Chinese dining in Greater Hobart. The Digital Value Proposition (DVP) is: "Savour clean, high-quality, and authentic Chinese tradition. The perfect group dining experience for your family and friends in Hobart."

6. DSMM Strategies and Tactics

A Spring Food Bar will deploy the strategic PESO framework to organise its digital channels (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016).

- **Owned Media (Website SEO):** Optimise the website by embedding local search keywords (e.g., "clean family restaurant Hobart") and high-resolution venue images, updated dynamically. *Delivery:* Achieves Objective 1 by boosting local search indexing to drive 25% more traffic. *Suitability:* Local families rely on Google to verify restaurant cleanliness before booking group tables (Leachman & Scheibenreif, 2023).
- **Shared Media (TikTok & Instagram Reels):** Establish official accounts to publish short-form videos 2–3 times per week following the AIDA model with visual hooks and bilingual captions. *Delivery:* Achieves Objective 3 by triggering social algorithms to gain 500 followers. *Suitability:*

Young consumers spend hours on short video platforms and prefer dynamic video over text to discover local dining (Quesenberry, 2016).

- **Earned Media (Google Reviews):** Feature the 4.6-star rating prominently on the website homepage and implement post-purchase counter signage prompting feedback. **Delivery:** Achieves Objective 2 by leveraging real-time customer satisfaction to grow reviews by 20%. **Suitability:** Modern diners cross-check online ratings to reduce uncertainty before visiting unfamiliar restaurants (Chakravorti et al., 2021).
- **Paid Media (Meta Ads & Influencers):** Deploy weekly localised Facebook and Instagram ads targeting users aged 25–55 near Hobart, paired with monthly local food influencer collaborations. **Delivery:** Accelerates dine-in traffic by pushing targeted promotions onto local feeds. **Suitability:** Meta platforms offer precise demographic and location targeting to reach parents efficiently (Duffer et al., 2025).

7. DSMM Privacy, Security, Legal, and Ethical Considerations

A Spring Food Bar complies with Australian laws and ethical standards to protect consumer data (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016). Under the Privacy Act 1988, since the website collects customer names, phone numbers, and payment details, a Privacy Policy must be placed in the footer with secure encryption to prevent leaks. To comply with the Spam Act 2003, any future marketing messages require explicit opt-in consent from users and a clear unsubscribe button. Ethically, all social media collaborations on TikTok and Instagram Reels must use disclosures like #ad to maintain trust (Blackman & Niño, 2023). Finally, the restaurant will only gather real customer feedback through store signs, strictly banning fake Google reviews.

8. DSMM Analytics, Evaluation, and Measurement

A Spring Food Bar will conduct monthly quantitative and qualitative data evaluations using standard industry tools to ensure performance alignment (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016).

- **Objective 1 (Traffic) KPIs:** Track monthly unique organic web visitors, total page views, and direct click-through rates (CTR) on the ordering button utilising Google Analytics 4 (GA4).
- **Objective 2 (Reviews) KPIs:** Measure the volume of monthly reviews (target: 20% increase) and monitor the star rating via the Google Business Profile Dashboard. Qualitative assessment involves sentiment analysis of review text to track cleanliness feedback.

- Objective 3 (Social) KPIs: Monitor follower growth (target: 500), video view counts, engagement rates, and completion rates using TikTok Analytics and Instagram Insights. Qualitative assessment includes monitoring user comment themes.
- Review Process: The restaurant manager will review these performance reports at the conclusion of each month to dynamically adjust content tactics and targeted search keywords.

9. DSMM Implementation Control Plan and Budget

The 12-month marketing campaign operates on an allocated total budget of \$6,000 AUD. Operational execution is divided between the Restaurant Manager and a part-time bilingual Social Media Coordinator.

12-Month Implementation and Budget Matrix

Digital Channel	Tactics & Frequency	Timeline	Budget Allocation	Assigned Responsibility
Owned Media	Website SEO optimisation; quarterly photo updates.	Months 1–2 (Setup); Months 3–12 (Updates)	\$1,000 AUD (17%)	Restaurant Manager
Shared Media	2–3 AIDA bilingual short videos per week.	Months 1–12 (Continuous)	\$1,200 AUD (20%)	Social Media Coordinator
Earned Media	In-store QR code counter signs; daily comment replies.	Months 1–12 (Daily)	\$300 AUD (5%)	Manager & Front-of-house Staff
Paid Media	Weekly localised Meta ads; monthly influencer clips.	Months 1–3 (Launch); Months 4–12 (Maintenance)	\$3,500 AUD (58%)	Social Media Coordinator

Budget Allocation Justification Logic

The allocation logic concentrates capital on Paid Media (58%) and Shared Media (20%) because establishing an online presence from zero requires immediate, aggressive paid reach via hyper-local ads and trusted influencers to efficiently reach Hobart families and students (Duffer et al., 2025).

Conversely, Owned Media (SEO) and Earned Media (Reviews) rely primarily on internal staff labour

rather than high ad spend, allowing the firm to reach its 25% traffic and 20% review growth targets with minimal financial capital (\$1,300 combined) (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016).

10. Proposed Recommendations

Recommendation 1: Combine influencer clips into a regular posting schedule.

- Rationale: To make sure the new TikTok and Instagram accounts do not go completely silent after the monthly influencer collaboration ends, the restaurant must repurpose those influencer videos into regular, smaller updates to keep local audiences engaged (Quesenberry, 2016).
- Expected Outcome: Maintain a steady flow of local followers and steady social media views.

Recommendation 2: Guide social media viewers directly to the official website.

- Rationale: Instead of letting social media followers order through expensive third-party apps like Uber Eats, all video links and ad buttons must lead directly to the venue's own secure ordering portal to save on high commission fees (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2016).
- Expected Outcome: Increase the profit margins of direct online ordering traffic within 3 months.

Recommendation 3: Build a simple, compliant email and SMS list.

- Rationale: When customers use the website to order or scan the counter signage, inviting them to check a box for future discount codes allows the restaurant to text them directly next time for free, without paying for Meta ads again (Blackman & Niño, 2023).
- Expected Outcome: Reduce long-term marketing costs while keeping customer data safe.

11. Conclusion

In conclusion, this digital marketing plan helps fix the big gap between A Spring Food Bar's strong physical business and its weak online presence. By using the PESO model, the strategy gives the restaurant a clear roadmap to save money from expensive third-party delivery apps and grow its own website orders. The plan uses the restaurant's good 4.6-star Google rating to attract two main target groups, which are local Hobart families and Chinese international students. This is done by using local

SEO and bilingual videos on TikTok and Instagram Reels. To achieve the SMART objectives, the business will use a realistic budget of \$6,000 AUD over 12 months, dividing the work between paid ads and internal staff. Finally, the long-term recommendations like sending social media viewers directly to the official website and creating a safe customer list will help the restaurant save marketing costs later. Overall, this plan follows Australian laws and helps A Spring Food Bar improve its quality to achieve long-term business growth in the Hobart market.

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